

Fellowship Claim Approval Workflow

How a Research Fellow's monthly stipend claim is approved. This is a short, three-stage linear chain — the PI who supervises the Fellow, the HOD, and the Dean — with one deliberate asymmetry: the PI cannot send a claim back for correction, only approve or reject it outright.

Raised by Research Fellow Stages 3 Terminal outcomes Approved · Rejected

Before a claim can even be raised: it must fall within the Fellow's appointment period, no other active (non-rejected) claim may already exist for the same month, and if the House Rent Allowance component is being claimed, the HRA slip document must already be on file.

APPROVAL SEQUENCE

1

With PI

Approve (forwards)

Reject

The initial stage. The Fellow's own supervising PI reviews the claim and either approves it — which forwards it to the HOD — or rejects it outright. **There is no "return for correction" option at this stage;** a PI rejection ends the claim.

WHY The PI sits closest to the Fellow and already knows whether the claimed hours and leave are accurate. The BRD gives the PI a binary decision on purpose — approve what's correct, reject what isn't — rather than a return path that would let a claim bounce indefinitely between Fellow and PI before it ever reaches the office.

2

With HOD

Approve

Reject

Return

The Head of Department can approve (forwarding to the Dean), reject outright, or return the claim for correction.

3

With Dean

Approve

Reject

Return

The Dean gives final sign-off: approve, reject, or return for correction.



Approved / Rejected

Terminal. Approval at the Dean's stage closes the claim for payment; rejection at any stage ends it without payment.

WHY Any return — whether issued by the HOD or by the Dean — sends the claim all the way back to **With PI**, not to whichever stage returned it. The PI is the only stage that can act on the Fellow's behalf to revise a claim, so re-entry always starts there, and the claim must earn the PI's approval again before climbing back up.

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED

DOCUMENT	STATUS
Generated Stipend Form	Mandatory
HRA Slip	Optional – required only if the HRA component is claimed
Signed Claim Form	Mandatory